

Extracting Needs: instructions and notes

Day 3 · Session 4 | Both sectors | Shared resource

How This Exercise Works

Work in pairs. Decide who is Role A and who is Role B for Round 1. Role A reads only the Round 1 scenario brief below; Role B reads only the Extractor Instructions. After eight minutes, swap: the Round 1 Role B becomes Role A for Round 2, using the Round 2 scenario brief, and the Round 1 Role A becomes the Round 2 extractor.

Do not read the other round's Role A brief before it is your turn to use it — discovering it in the moment is the whole exercise.

ROLE B — EXTRACTOR INSTRUCTIONS (used both rounds)

Your partner will state a position once. From that point, your only tool is open questions — no arguing, no proposing solutions, no stating your own view.

Your goal: Identify the real underlying need behind your partner's stated position, through skilful, genuinely curious questioning alone.

What to avoid: Leading questions that supply the answer; arguing with the position; proposing a solution before the need is genuinely surfaced.

Useful question starters: "Help me understand why..." · "What would it mean for you if..." · "What's the concern behind..." · "What would need to be true for..."

When to stop: When you believe you have genuinely identified the real need — or when time is called.

Extraction Notes

As Role B, use this space to jot down what you believe the real underlying need is, before comparing notes with your partner.

Prompt	Your notes
Round 1 — what I believe the real need is	
Round 1 — which question actually opened things up	
Round 2 — what I believe the real need is	
Round 2 — which question actually opened things up	